

Figure 5.17 *Lashkari Bazar, South Palace, south portal detail. From Sourdel-Thomine 1978: pl. 54d.*

But given the long list of renovations, and particularly the nature of some of them, it is improbable that all the projects listed above were executed in the late 1150s. Major renovations would have been unlikely just a few years after 'Ala' al-Din *Jahan-suz*'s willful destructiveness there and in its environs, even though he might have ultimately planned to occupy the area – along with Ghazna itself – but ultimately left this to his next campaign in the region (cf. Chapters 1 and 3).

Angular Kufic doxologies, such as *al-mulk li-llah*, were added to the palace's main southern façade (Figures 5.15 and 5.16), as well as the interior court façades (Figures 5.14, 5.19). Such simple epigraphy was a far cry from the sophisticated verses on the dadoes of the Ghazna palace's central court, composed in various meters of the Persian poetic tradition and possibly glorifying the Ghaznavids' dynastic lineage and expounding legal and theological tenets. But at least in content – the rarity of *in situ* remains at Lashkari Bazar prevents stylistic comparison – the simple sayings *were*